

Dawn Gabriel

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SUMMARY

Engineering leader and hands-on builder with 20+ years delivering software and leading teams across consulting, higher education, and independent product development. Proven at founding and scaling engineering practices, leading teams large and small, owning client delivery and technical direction, and building AI-assisted delivery workflows from scratch. Combines deep software development experience with excellent stakeholder communication and project management acumen. Passionate about zero-to-one environments and defining how teams adopt AI.

EXPERIENCE

Manager, Technical Consulting — EY, NYC

April 2024 – Present

Leading two disaster recovery grant engagements built on EY Grants Accelerator (EYGA) with Microsoft Power Platform in Azure, overseeing engineering, business analysis, and QA across active development and ongoing operations.

FDACS — Statewide Disaster Recovery Grants Platform (O&M)

- Led delivery of a statewide disaster recovery grants platform across forensics, case management, and customer service workstreams (~20-person team); the platform has processed 1,300+ applications and \$88.45M in approved funding and is now in operations and maintenance.

GKN — Disaster Recovery Grant Program (active build)

- Leading AI-assisted, spec-driven delivery of a disaster recovery grants application with a cross-functional team of business consultants, forensic specialists, product managers, designers, and engineers, using AI to generate PRDs, test plans, tickets, and requirements traceability; achieving 4x delivery speed compared with similar engagements.
- Built an agent to generate daily executive delivery dashboards, replacing 30–60 minutes of manual reporting per update.

NYC OTI — Small Business Services Portal & AEM Migration (2025)

- Led an 18-person engineering team across the SBS Portal (AWS, Spring Boot, React) and an Adobe AEM CMS migration; set technical strategy and security standards.

NYC Department of Education — Risk Team (in progress)

- Scoped and directed development of a Microsoft Copilot agent over standardized documents to normalize Risk team reporting, with projected savings of 60+ hours per quarter over manual reviews.

AI Adoption, Team Growth & Additional Engagements

- Translated EY's spec-driven development methodology into go-to-market materials for public-sector pursuits.
- Helped grow EY delivery teams through candidate interviews, campus recruiting outreach, and recruiting mid-career professionals.
- Tech lead for a 6-engineer Databricks MLOps transformation kickoff for Vizient Healthcare (Python, Azure).

Senior Software Engineer / Technical Lead — Nuvalence (acquired by EY)

January 2023 – April 2024

- Technical lead for NY State DMV online license and permit renewal (Java, Spring Boot, Google Cloud, Angular); led 5 engineers through post-acquisition transition.
- Led 5 engineers on Ford Credit's customer identity work (Java, Spring Boot, Google Cloud); gathered stakeholder requirements, set engineering priorities, and secured team adoption of a two-week release cycle.

Principal Software Engineer / Tech Lead — Harvard Business School, Cambridge, MA

January 2008 – January 2023

- Partnered directly with faculty to define product scope and prioritize iterations based on faculty and student feedback, translating research concepts into interactive learning experiences.
- Served as primary or sole developer for commercially licensed simulations used across MBA and Executive Education programs; transformed R/Python research models into classroom applications with Scala/Play, TypeScript, Java/Spring, Angular, SQL databases, and MongoDB.
- Owned product lifecycles from prototypes through production and maintenance handoffs; created departmental code-review and development-completion standards.
- Led front-end, DevOps, and data science delivery against fixed academic deadlines; managed deployments on Linux and later AWS, and supported live classroom simulations.
- Mentored and managed Year Up interns and junior developers; reviewed work from internationally distributed development teams.

Independent AI Product Development — Flaught, MysteryMixClub, tktk

2023 – Present

Own independent products from problem definition and personas through PRDs, technical design, implementation, and launch.

- **Flaught (open source)**: built a CI code-review agent combining LLM review with deterministic checks to address failures in AI-assisted development; advocated for inclusion in an internal EY AI development toolkit (TypeScript).
- **MysteryMixClub**: took a streaming-service-agnostic music discovery PWA from concept to beta; used Claude Code and Codex to port it to iOS in days, with the app now in App Store review (Python, React, Postgres).
- **tktk**: building a multi-tenant micro-LMS for writing workshops, working directly with poets to meet specific workflow needs within near-zero budgets (Cloudflare Workers, Hono, D1/Drizzle, Hono JSX, htmx 4.0).

Early Career— Cambridge, MA

1996 – 2007

- Senior software engineer at American Well, AspenTech, and Virtual Text (Java).
- Software engineer, Stumpworld Systems: e-commerce for clients including Phish, Kiss, and Aerosmith (VB, PHP).
- Junior software engineer and 8th employee at Spinners, Inc., the first startup of Wayfair founders Niraj Shah and Steve Conine (VB, Perl, PHP).

SKILLS

Leadership & delivery: client engagement ownership, cross-functional team leadership, technical strategy, engineering standards, mentoring, requirements and scope definition, release planning, pre-sales scoping

Engineering & AI: AI-assisted development (Claude Code, Codex, pi.dev, Copilot 365), LLM applications and agents, adversarial evaluation, CI/CD, Java, Python, Scala, TypeScript, React, AWS, Azure, GCP, Terraform

PRESENTATIONS

“Leveraging Generative AI to Negotiate Software Development Priorities” — Lightning talk, Grace Hopper Conference, Sep 2023